

Ali Firat Celik

Ankara, Turkey

+90 531 349 92 30 • celik@alifirat.xyz • github.com/celikj

Senior undergraduate in Computer Engineering at Middle East Technical University (METU), with experience in AI research, mobile development, and systems automation.

Education

Middle East Technical University (METU)

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

Ankara, Turkey

2022 – 2027 (expected)

Ranked 566th out of approximately 3 million participants in Türkiye's National University Entrance Exam (YKS).

Work Experience

Baykar

Artificial Intelligence Software Development Intern

Istanbul, Turkey

August 2026 – September 2026 (incoming)

xAI

Human Data Tutor (Contract)

Palo Alto, California (Remote)

December 2025 – June 2026

Evaluated and ranked AI model outputs to improve reasoning, coding capability, and factual accuracy. Authored high-quality technical prompts and reference solutions.

METUApp

Maintainer

Ankara, Turkey

July 2025 – September 2025

Maintained **METUApp**, the official mobile application used by METU students. Diagnosed and resolved user-reported bugs, reproduced issues, and verified fixes; collaborated with the development team to improve application stability and user experience.

METU AIRLAB, Informatics Institute, METU

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Ankara, Turkey

May 2025 – September 2025

Worked under Assoc. Prof. Dr. Erdem Akagündüz on a TÜBİTAK TEYDEB-funded **deep learning** project for **vision and graphics**: a prototype system generating interactive graphics in real time from live camera input.

Personal Projects

TaskLock — iOS App Blocker github.com/celikj/psychic-giggle App Store

Built and shipped an iOS app that blocks distracting apps system-wide using Apple's **Family Controls**, **DeviceActivity**, and **ManagedSettings** frameworks — enforced at the OS level rather than a dismissible timer. Implemented in **React**, **TypeScript**, and **Capacitor** with a custom native **Swift** plugin and three app extensions (Shield UI, DeviceActivity monitor, WidgetKit widget) sharing state through an App Group. Integrated **RevenueCat** subscriptions and **Aptabase** privacy-first analytics; CI/CD via GitHub Actions runs typechecking, unit and e2e tests, and cloud-signed TestFlight builds on every change. Handled the full App Store submission process, including privacy compliance, subscription review, and entitlements configuration.

METU SKSDB Reservation Automation

Automation tool for reserving gym slots on METU's SKSDB system, built with **Python** and **Selenium**. Integrated an audio-to-text model to solve CAPTCHA challenges during authentication.

METU Registration System Automation

Automated METU's course registration workflow with **Python** and **Selenium**. Used **Tesseract OCR** to solve CAPTCHAs, with **OpenCV** preprocessing of noisy text images.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Swift, TypeScript/JavaScript, C++, Bash

Frameworks & Libraries: React, Capacitor, Selenium, OpenCV, Tesseract OCR

Tools & Platforms: Linux, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, L^AT_EX

Languages

Turkish: Native proficiency

English: Fluent proficiency